

High-Protein Vegan Nutrition Guide

Fuel Your Fitness with Plants

Introduction

Contrary to popular belief, it is entirely possible to build muscle and achieve peak fitness on a 100% plant-based diet. This guide provides the tools, meal ideas, and protein sources to help you thrive as a vegan athlete or fitness enthusiast.

Top Plant-Based Protein Sources

1. **Tempeh:** 31g protein per cup.
2. **Lentils:** 18g protein per cup (cooked).
3. **Seitan:** 25g protein per 3.5oz.
4. **Hemp Seeds:** 10g protein per 3 tablespoons.
5. **Tofu (Extra Firm):** 10g protein per half cup.
6. **Chickpeas/Beans:** 15g protein per cup (cooked).
7. **Quinoa:** 8g protein per cup (cooked).
8. **Pumpkin Seeds:** 9g protein per ounce.

Sample Meal Plan

- **Breakfast:** Scrambled Tofu with nutritional yeast, spinach, and whole-grain toast.
- **Lunch:** Mediterranean Quinoa Bowl with chickpeas, cucumber, olives, and tahini dressing.
- **Snack:** Apple slices with almond butter or a vegan protein shake.
- **Dinner:** Lentil Shepherd's Pie with a side of steamed broccoli.

Tips for Optimizing Nutrition

- **Mix Your Sources:** Eating a variety of protein sources ensures a complete amino acid profile.
- **Don't Forget B12:** Supplementation is essential for long-term vegan health.
- **Focus on Whole Foods:** Limit processed "fake meats" and prioritize legumes, grains, and nuts.
- **Stay Hydrated:** High-fiber diets require plenty of water for optimal digestion.

Protein Cheat Sheet

Keep this in your kitchen for quick reference when meal planning!

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